

To meet this challenge, Cornell University has launched the Precision Behavioural Health Initiative that could enable health industry professionals to leverage smart devices and artificial intelligence (AI) to better monitor and manage mental health of the patients. Especially for people with

bipolar disorder or schizophrenia, this would prove critical in identifying early-intervention treatments. Through machine learning algorithms, a lot of data can be handled to provide meaningful interpretations for better patient outcomes.

Engineers inspired by vines develop soft robotic gripper

Drawing inspiration from pole bean vines, engineers at the University of Georgia College of Engineering have designed a

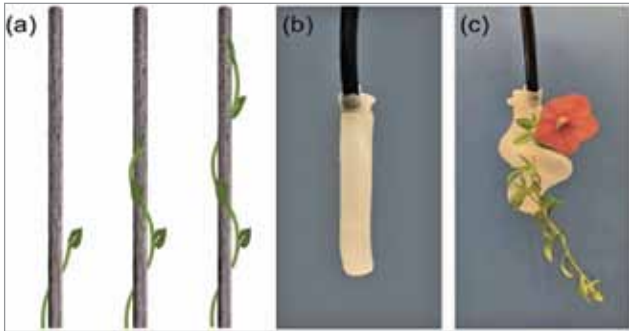


Illustration of the twining motion in twining plant (a); Soft spiral gripper before actuation (b); Actuated soft spiral gripper holding a flower (c)
(Credit: www.osapublishing.org/oe; <https://news.uga.edu>)

new soft robotic gripper. While pole beans and other twining plants use their touch-sensitive shoots to wrap themselves around supports like ropes and rods to grow upward, the robot is designed to firmly but gently grasp objects as small as one millimetre in diameter.

The soft robotic spiral gripper offers several advantages over existing robotic devices. A single pneumatic control facilitates the robotic gripper to work well in confined areas and needs only a small operational space. The device also offers another advancement over many existing robotics in the form of an embedded sensor in the middle of the robot's elastic spine that can sense the twining angle, the physical parameters of the target and any external disturbances that might cause the target to come loose—all in real time. The soft robotic gripper, a little more than seven centimetres long and fashioned from silicone could be useful in many settings, including agriculture, medicine, and research.

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